Michaela Haripersad

Business Development | Executive Support | Operations
Stakeholder Engagement | Research & Coordination

Johannesburg, Gauteng, South Africa | Email: michaelaharipersad@gmail.com

Professional Summary

Business development and executive support professional with experience in business development research, stakeholder mapping, executive briefing, office operations and event coordination, and exposure to tenders and proposal work. Currently a Business Development Intern at Motsoeneng Bill Incorporated, a law, forensics and advisory firm: researches prospective clients and decision-makers, prepares meeting briefs for the Managing Partner, maintains the Business Development Hitlist Dashboard, takes meeting minutes and briefing notes, and has been entrusted to communicate directly with a prospective client on the firm's behalf. Trained in Ghost Practice, tender administration and compliance, and cybersecurity awareness.

Brings persistence and ownership, takes responsibility, learns quickly, adapts readily and creates value for the business. Detail-oriented and motivated, with a passion for exceptional customer service and supporting business operations; takes direction well, contributes constructively in discussions, executes reliably and is willing to do far more than expected.

Target roles: Business Development Executive or Consultant; Client Relationship Management; Executive and Business Support; Project or Operations Coordinator; Stakeholder or Corporate Affairs; Tender, Bid or Proposal Coordinator.

Skills

Business Development and Research: Business development research and analysis, opportunity identification, target and stakeholder identification and mapping, decision-maker and Heads of Legal identification, meeting briefs, contact and stakeholder databases, information verification, affiliations research, forensics-related research, commercial awareness.

Tenders and Proposals: Tender administration (introductory), tenders (RFQ, eTenders, EOI), bid document review, compulsory briefings, proposal-related work, procurement research, legal and professional terminology (developing).

Executive and Business Support: Executive research and briefing, minute-taking, briefing notes, calendar management, meeting and boardroom preparation, documentation preparation, booking and accommodation arrangements, office operations and administration, reception, HR-related support, data entry, file and information management.

Operations and Coordination: Event and logistics coordination, cross-functional coordination, facilities and vendor coordination, procurement, workspace planning, marketing, content and communications, debt collection support.

Client Service: Client and stakeholder service, stakeholder management, reception and hospitality, internal and external communication, telephone etiquette, Customer Resolution Management, Problem Resolution, Listening Skills.

Software and Systems: Ghost Practice, Hitlist Dashboard, Microsoft Office (Word, Excel, Outlook, PowerPoint, Teams), Debt flow and AOM systems, shared drives and ZIP folders, online research and booking platforms, professional networking sources, telephone systems, printers and scanners, AI productivity tools, business systems.

Professional Strengths: Persistence, ownership, accountability, taking responsibility, initiative, problem solving, critical thinking, learning quickly, adaptability, professional resilience, professional confidence, creating value.

Organisation and Teamwork: Organisational skills, project and task management, time management, attention to detail, Team Player, teamwork and collaboration, Process Optimization, Administrative Leadership.

Professional Experience

Business Development Intern

Motsoeneng Bill Incorporated | March 2026 - Present

Twelve-month internship programme (ending 1 March 2027) in a cross-functional role spanning business development, executive support, operations, tenders and proposals, events, and stakeholder engagement.

Business Development and Research

- Research prospective clients, organisations, decision-makers and Heads of Legal, verifying company and contact details from multiple sources, to support relationship mapping and new business opportunities and partnerships.
- Prepare meeting briefs ("cheat sheets") for the Managing Partner on companies, stakeholders, organisational structures and opportunities, monitoring upcoming meetings so that briefs are ready in advance.
- Review, update and reprint cheat sheets with current contacts, Heads of Legal and target data; proposed splitting the work by strengths (company research and quality review, contact sourcing), improving workflow and collaboration.
- Update and maintain the Business Development Hitlist Dashboard of company details, contacts, Heads of Legal, targets and opportunities for the Managing Partner, adding and correcting information and improving its structure and usability.
- Take part in business development strategy discussions on lead generation, touchpoints and client targeting; support firm strategy initiatives and research, and coordinate participation in industry events.
- Entrusted to communicate directly with a prospective company on the firm's behalf, supporting a Forensics Partner; sent the firm's company profile and B-BBEE certificate to present its capabilities.
- Helped a Forensics Partner arrange an introductory meeting with a prospective client, maintaining contact with the client representative and assisting with meeting coordination and preparation.
- Researched a prospective client's supplier registration and procurement requirements, compiled the information for internal use and assisted with preparing supplier registration communication.

- Completed a two-day affiliations research project with a colleague, consolidating professional, industry and organisational affiliations for senior review.

Tenders, RFQs and Proposals

- Exposure to tender processes, including RFQs (Requests for Quotation), eTenders and EOIs (Expressions of Interest); contribute to proposal-related work.
- Received practical on-the-job training from the Tender Specialist/Tender Manager on interpreting bid documents and completing the administrative portions of tender submissions, using live tender and RFQ documents as a learning tool.
- Attended three compulsory tender briefings (an Expression of Interest, a public-sector panel tender and an RFQ), capturing notes and communicating the information to senior colleagues to support proposal preparation, and raising a question for clarification at the RFQ briefing.

Executive and Administrative Support

- Provide ad hoc support to senior management and to associates and partners: coordinate meetings, follow-ups and internal reporting, prepare documents and track key deliverables.
- Prepare boardrooms and meeting spaces, arrange catering and required items, purchase items needed for meetings and maintain calendar awareness for meetings and visitors.
- Captured formal meeting minutes, minutes of a virtual consultation for the Managing Partner and structured notes at a virtual briefing session, documenting key discussions, decisions and action points in a clear, professional format.
- Researched and arranged accommodation near the court venue for an associate and client attending court proceedings, booked appointments for the Managing Partner and sourced items and tickets for his events.
- Delivered same-evening research on relevant individuals for the Managing Partner's out-of-town meetings, and reviewed and clipped lengthy video recordings into accessible sections.

Operations, Events and Facilities

- Handle day-to-day operational requirements and facilities matters, including office equipment, maintenance and vendor coordination, and monitor operational tools such as company vehicle trip logs and Uber reports.
- Plan and coordinate firm participation in events and initiatives and manage logistics for internal and external meetings, for example stadium bookings and cancellations.
- Support marketing and communications: content, internal and external platforms, branding and marketing initiatives.
- Coordinated furnishing procurement and conceptual layout planning for the executive office workspace.
- Assisted with resolving technical and logistical matters for the Managing Partner's office television installation, liaising with the logistics and finance departments on payment and access arrangements.
- Coordinated external service providers, including a pest-control inspection and treatment (quotations, follow-ups, stakeholder updates), consolidated the related correspondence and reviewed vendor invoices and documentation so that records reflected the firm's correct name and were organised for internal records.
- Supported the firm's convention: coordinated art equipment and professional artists with relevant parties, assisted with the Managing Partner's presentation, supported practical event coordination and contributed through singing.
- Accompanied the firm's messenger on office procurement, gaining exposure to operations, budgeting and purchasing.

Reception, Client Experience and Onboarding

- Cover reception when unstaffed, including taking ownership on days both receptionists were absent: answer and transfer calls, receive visitors, handle general enquiries and refer matters to the right person or department.
- Coordinated with the Marketing and Design teams to implement guest Wi-Fi QR code access at reception, and assisted with developing and placing reception pamphlets with guest Wi-Fi information for visitors and clients.
- Welcomed and orientated a new employee and two vacation students, covering office tours, introductions to departments and employees, seating and office familiarisation.

Ghost Practice, File Management and Debt Collection

- Use Ghost Practice to search for companies and matters, learning how client, matter and firm information can be accessed and used for business development.
- Sort, organise and manage files, applying ZIP folder and file-management guidance from IT and Software Engineering.
- Assist with debtor follow-ups, calls on municipal accounts and tracking spreadsheets, using Debt flow and AOM systems; attended a two-day Debt Collection Course.
- Worked with an Associate Partner on a Ghost Practice file and information-management task, consulting a senior colleague and the Software Engineering team to make the process more efficient for Partners and implementing the agreed folder structure; positive feedback led to a further matter from a second Partner (in progress).

Modelling, Recording and Filming

Toast Talent Modelling Agency, Johannesburg, South Africa | July 2024 - October 2024

- Applied self-motivation and a strong sense of personal responsibility to manage time effectively across modelling opportunities, casting calls for advertisements and recording original music within deadlines.
- Learned quickly and adapted to perform in front of cameras for a TV show appearance in 2024.
- Communicated effectively and worked both independently and collaboratively in a team environment, as required for writing and recording music, filming and modelling.

Junior Administrator

2 ONE 2 Blue Star (authorised by SANLAM), Johannesburg, South Africa | September 2023 - June 2024

- Provided excellent administrative support, gaining experience in managing screening processes, setting up debit orders, completing premium holiday forms, making appointments for clients, managing calendars and preparing documentation.
- Handled customer service issues in an excellent, friendly and knowledgeable manner, ensuring client satisfaction.
- Educated customers on special company offerings; assisted customers with making payments, establishing payment plans and updating their personal information; handled incoming calls, enquiries and service requests from clients.
- **Managing files:** Ensured timely and accurate data entry into the system, and reviewed file records and other documents to enable appropriate responses to customer requests.
- **Active listening and communication:** Used these skills to address customer enquiries, escalate issues to the manager and work collaboratively with the team.

Certifications and Training

Motsoeneng Bill Incorporated: Certificates of Attendance (2026)

- **Tender Administration & Compliance Management** | 23 April 2026 | SAQA Number 243112
- **MB Cybersecurity Awareness Training (2 hours)** | 2 April 2026 | SAQA Number 117926

Dye & Durham GhostPractice (GP): Training Course Certificates (2026)

- **Mastering Invoices with GP** | 31 March 2026
- **Working on your Files Efficiently with GP** | 19 March 2026
- **Creating and Maintaining your files with GP** | 17 March 2026

Workplace Training (2026)

- **Drafting and Formatting Training** (legal perspective) | September 2026 | Instructor-led, approximately 1.5 hours
- **Practical IT and File Management Guidance** | September 2026 | One-on-one with IT and Software Engineering colleagues, 10 minutes
- **Administrative Staff Training: Client Satisfaction and Hospitality** | August 2026 | Group, in-person
- **Mokgabolo knowledge-sharing sessions** | May 2026 - August 2026 | Attended firm presentations (May); assisted with session preparation and administration (July); took part in a cross-functional session with Business Development, HR, Labour/Legal and Economics colleagues and helped set it up (August).
- **Tender / Bid Document Training** | July 2026 | Practical on-the-job training, 1 to 2 hours
- **Debt Collection Course** | May 2026 | Two-day course

Earlier Certificates

- **Paraplanner-Legislation/Risk Certificate** | 2 ONE 2 Blue Star, Johannesburg, South Africa | 2024
  Modules: The Value of Family-Funeral Plan, The Value Funeral Plan, Enhance Family-Funeral, Enhance Funeral Plan and Income Plan, Life Risk Policy, Savings: Retail Pension Benefits, Paraplanner Savings / Life Investment Policy.
- **Blue Essence Certificate Course** | 2 ONE 2 Blue Star, Johannesburg, South Africa | 2023
  Modules: Sanfin, Communication, Sanport, Advice Partner for Sales Support, Compliance, Digital Enablement, Overview of Sanlam Life Products.

Education

Higher Certificate in Business Management (NQF 5)

IQ Academy, Johannesburg, South Africa | 2023

Modules: Project Management, Human Resources Management, Finance for Managers, Marketing Management, Principles of Leadership, Academic Literacy.

Matric

Randpark High School, Johannesburg, South Africa | January 2022 - December 2022

Subjects: English Language, Afrikaans, Mathematical Literacy, Business Management, Life Sciences, Art.

- Recipient of Full Colours for Performing Arts, 2022.

Languages

English, Afrikaans

Interests

Entertainment, music, presenting, acting, networking and entrepreneurship.

References

References are available on request.